

Knox County

Anders, John

OWLS HEAD

I am seeking to serve as a delegate because our country continues to face attacks on its constitutional boundaries and civil liberties. As a U.S. Coast Guard veteran, I took a solemn oath to support and defend the Constitution. Today, structural threats to our democracy - including corporate capture, the privatization of public functions, the mining and sale of Americans' personal data by private firms, the weaponization of automated AI profiling for domestic surveillance, and policies that destabilize our monetary framework - directly threaten Maine's operational sovereignty, our civil liberties, and fundamental human rights.? We are witnessing a convergence of risks: mass surveillance systems that erode Fourth Amendment protections against unreasonable search and seizure; the commercialization of private data and behavioral tracking that strips citizens of meaningful privacy; the outsourcing of public authority to private entities in ways that weaken First Amendment accountability; the militarization of immigration and customs enforcement on U.S. soil; gross uses of force situations that violate basic constitutional standards; and killings involving federal agents that demand accountability, due process, and strict oversight. These developments, combined with economic policies that resemble taxation without meaningful representation, represent a systemic departure from the constitutional order our institutions are meant to uphold.? My background in federal law enforcement taught me that authority must always be bound by strict constitutional guardrails. In 1791, Alexander Hamilton charged the first officers of our service to remember that their countrymen are freemen, instructing that their deportment be marked with "prudence, moderation and good temper."

Andrews, Loren J

CUSHING

My name is Loren Andrews, and I am proudly running as a Troy Jackson delegate because I know he's the best person to represent us in the United States Senate, working hard on issues that Maine people care about, or affordability, fairness, Medicare for all, and taking down the billionaire class. Right now, I'm a clinical social worker in Rockland, I live in Cushing, and I teach at the University Maine in its social work program. I also served on the RSU13 board of directors for 17 years, including eight years as the chair of that committee. I strongly believe in serving our communities, like Troy Jackson does. Before all of that, I worked for Democratic candidates who ran for President of the United States, the House of Representatives, and the Maine Legislature. I'm a Democrat to my core, I will always fight for our issues, especially the ones we need to focus on now related to all the working families in the state of Maine, and across our country. Troy Jackson is the person to get that done, he will carry on working for progressive issues like these because he has for decades, as he did when he was President of the Maine Senate. I've met Troy, I know him personally, and I know his commitment will never change,

because it never has. I hope you will support me as a delegate from Knox County to the upcoming Democratic State Convention next week.

Austin, Sarah

ROCKLAND

As a delegate to the Nominating convention, I would focus on helping to select a candidate that is willing to challenge injustice, who will be accountable for the platform that they are promoting, and who will communicate with the people of Maine in a meaningful and ongoing way. Through my community activities I have a wide circle that includes people of many ages, classes, and other categories. I want to make sure their voices are heard in this process.

Babbitt, Jane G

CAMDEN

As part of Audacity CAT I've been deeply involved in weekly demonstrations, mashing signs and buttons, and being part of the silent Signs of Fascism vigils. I want to get rid of Susan Collins with every fiber of my being. I've previously worked phone banks and I'll do it again, in addition to my work with Audacity CAT.

Baines, Susan L

SOUTH THOMASTON

I would feel honored to serve as a delegate to the Nominating Committee in this most consequential and interesting time. It is important to me to listen to the concerns of my neighbors in choosing our next senate candidate, to hear directly of their concerns, their hopes for their future as well as the future of the State of Maine and the country as a whole. For, although all politics is local, or as the saying goes, we all know what is at stake. Bodily autonomy, healthcare, affordable housing, education, and fair taxation of the billionaire class, immigration and the safety of our neighbors and world health. My number 1 and top priority is to choose someone who can beat the formidable Susan Collins. I do not fool myself, this will be a difficult task, but not impossible. I believe Maine is full of good candidates, smart people to choose them, and willing and energized volunteers. I am excited to hear and see who rises to the top of their minds. I am also very keen to make sure the process, and our conclusions, are reached in the most transparent manner so all may feel they have been heard, that we shape and control our own destiny. Only then can we band together to defeat Susan Collins. I feel Maine can be a shining example to the country of what democracy looks like, sounds like, and feels like.

Barlow, Shirley

THOMASTON

I want to become a delegate . As a life long Democrat I want to help Maine has the best qualified candidate to replace Susan Collin's. For decades she has not been supportive of all Mainers. She has under served the young, the elderly , the working lass and those most in need of support. We are voting to save our democracy this time and we must turn this destructive tide.

Bartke, Jesse

SAINT GEORGE

After a long time being a political observer, I have recently become more involved due to some events happening in my town of St. George. As a long time public educator, a parent and strong advocate for equal rights, I have seen my role shift in how we approach the challenges of the time. We are no longer in a world in which politics and morality can be seen as separate. We have to ensure that we are actively pushing for change to enable us to support those who need our support. This past year I have worked with a group of like minded community members to flip a school board seat to a more progressive candidate and almost defeat a member of the select board, who is very enmeshed in town happenings, for a more progressive candidate. I believe that the biggest impact we have directly has is in our local politics and I want to get more involved. We are already gearing up for next year's election to continue to flip the school board. I also believe that change happens when many people pitch in to support change. I believe in the political direction of the democratic party and I want to ensure we can continue to push towards progressive change and get Susan out of office.

Bartovics, Susan Layton

NORTH HAVEN

I have been a member of Knox County Democrats for years, and have been active in many campaigns in Maine and nationally. I have knocked of many doors, phone banked, collected signatures and help post card writing efforts. I see this opportunity as a way I can deepen my involvement in a time when our democracy cries out for greater participation from citizens. My advocacy experience has strengthened my voice and opened a window into the workings of Maine politics. I am deeply committed to the rule of law and feel strongly that the current Administration must be held accountable for its flagrant violation of those laws. I would be honored to serve as a Knox County Delegate.

Bates, Susan K

SAINT GEORGE

I would like to be part of the process of choosing a Democratic candidate for Senate to defeat Susan Collins and represent Maine in the Senate. Why me? I'm a good listener and good at leading and having open, respectful conversations. (I also follow directions very well. ;-) I'm well connected to my community and with many people throughout Maine with my work on non-profit boards for statewide organizations such as the ACLU-ME and Maine Math & Science Alliance. I've served on our library board, co-led an effort to bring broadband to our town, and I volunteer in our school. I thrive in situations where I can have conversations with random people, which makes it no surprise that grocery shopping at Hannaford's is a favorite activity. I can use that ease of speaking with strangers for canvassing to help defeat Susan Collins. I recognize the grief and frustration many are experiencing since Platner withdrew as our candidate. At the upcoming convention and in continuing to build a grassroots movement we'll meet voters with myriad emotions and opinions. I'll be a delegate that can meet the challenges that will arise in this unprecedented time. I'll also bring that posture after the convention as we continue to build a grass roots movement - one conversation at a time. I look forward to serving my State, the Democratic Party, and the values of integrity, compassion, and courage.

Baxter, Kathryn

ROCKLAND

I previously filled this out, but I will fill out again I sailed into Maine in 1986, weeks came from Bequia, St Vincent and the Grenadines, we represented that country in the Tall Ship parade. We fell in love with Maine and decided to buy a home in Hope ME where we raised our 3 children. I was appointed to Hope's school board and served as a member, then chair, and asked to run as high school school member of the CSD till 2005.

Disability

Bird, Lorin

ROCKLAND

I am glad the Democratic party can pull together a convention, of this type, so quickly. I want to do all I can to support my party in a transparent and democratic process that may go some way to healing the scandals and confusion, of recent days. I am a big believer in the ideals and goals of the Democratic party, in this campaign. I believe, with all my heart, that Troy Jackson is the best candidate to carry our standard and win in November. Choose me as a delegate and I will help the party make a smooth transition to Troy Jackson as our nominee, and, here's hoping, our next Senator!

Blake, Alan

THOMASTON

I serve on the Select Board of Thomaston Maine and see first hand how my community is reeling from the insane policies of our nation's government. I look forward to joining with fellow local democrats to sweep aside a government which is trampling all over the principles and values this country was founded on. I believe most Mainers know that our Progressive policies are the only way that ordinary people will achieve a decent quality of life in this country. I'll be doing my best to convince anyone with an open mind that voting for our chosen delegate is their best and maybe last chance to save the USA from a hellish future.

Bourgoine, Lindsay

ROCKPORT

My name is Lindsay Bourgoine. I live in Rockport with my family, but my roots are in Readfield, where I was raised in a politically active family that taught me public service matters. At 22, I walked into the State House in Augusta to represent a nonprofit and found myself often the youngest person in the room by decades. I cut my teeth. I worked hard. And I learned how to fight for what matters without losing sight of what it takes to win. Since then, my work has taken me from Maine to Colorado, across western statehouses, and to Capitol Hill—including many visits to Susan Collins' office. For years, people have asked when I would run. I used to say I would move home and run against Collins in 2026. My life took a different path, but my commitment to defeating her—and to building the future Maine families deserve—has never wavered. I am a Mainer, a mom of two young children, a graduate of Emerge, and a progressive advocate with a master's degree in public policy and deep experience in conservation, climate, and energy policy, as well as in leading federal advocacy strategy and managing national get-out-the-vote campaigns. I understand the stakes of this race and the work required to win it. I am ready to get to work, represent young progressive families in this movement, and bring my experience, urgency, and heart to the campaign ahead. Thank you for your consideration.

Bowers, James S

ROCKLAND

Keeping it brief. I'm not certain I can make the 7/19 meeting but will try. If selected I will be at the Nominating convention the 25th. Former member of the House, former Treasurer of the Democratic State Committee, former trustee of the University of Maine. Supporter of progressive causes since my first peace marches in the late 60s. Those who know me know. Jim

Brett Rabaioli, Mary

CAMDEN

I would like to serve as a delegate to the Nominating Convention because I want to play a part in shaping the Democratic agenda in Maine. I am a normal person who will do anything I can to defeat Susan Collins. I will make calls, host events and talk to others. I feel that Susan Collins needs to go and I desperately want to be a part of the movement to make that happen. Thank you.

Brock, Sheri

VINALHAVEN

I believe in the platform that Platner campaigned on, that it is both the right one for Maine and for the country. Considering the momentum and majority support he received, it is the one to finally defeat Collins. It is imperative that not only our loyal Democrats but also Independents and Republicans concerned with the direction the country is being taken in will participate in this endeavor for its best chance to succeed. With the attention this race has garnered, the momentum has great potential to inspire others to continue to fight for similar objectives. I truly believe this race should and can be won. I have served as a delegate previously and want to do everything I can to right the direction of our country and protect our amazing state.

Brock, Stephen

VINALHAVEN

I want to be a delegate to help Troy beat Susan!

Calkins, William

VINALHAVEN

I believe it is urgent that we, the democrats of Maine, maintain solidarity and choose a candidate that truly upholds a platform that fights for all the marginalized and oppressed peoples of our state and our nation. One that comes from, and truly fights for, unions and the working class. It is also crucial that our next senator does not abandon these values in international policy. A responsible domestic policy includes not sending our tax dollars to oppress others globally. Susan Collins has actively failed us at all of these goals. I plan to host meetings, provide access to signage for our community, distribute fact sheets about candidates and work to plan a meeting, remote or in person, where our community can get to know the democratic nominee.

Catus, Mary Brenna

CAMDEN

I am seeking to serve as a delegate because this moment is bigger than any one candidate. Our next nominee must earn the confidence of Democrats across Maine and build a coalition capable of defeating Susan Collins in November. This convention is an opportunity to unite around a candidate who reflects our values, inspires confidence, and can bring people together to move Maine forward. As a young voter and a person of color, I believe our party is strongest when every Mainer has a seat at the table. That means embracing the full diversity of our state, including racial, generational, geographic, socioeconomic, cultural, and lived diversity. We need a nominee who can represent, unite, and mobilize Mainers from every walk of life. Our diversity is one of our greatest strengths, and the voices shaping this decision should reflect the broad coalition we hope to build. Beyond the convention, I will continue organizing, volunteering, communicating, and mobilizing voters around a positive vision for Maine's future. We have an opportunity to turn this grassroots energy into lasting momentum by welcoming new voices, listening to one another, and building a party where every Mainer feels they belong. Together, we can unite behind a nominee who inspires Democrats, independents, and first-time voters alike, and finally defeat Susan Collins.

Cavanaugh, Ry

VINALHAVEN

I am a 55 year old Vinalhaven resident. I have no previous history of political involvement. Here's a moment where I think I can be of use. Let's pick a candidate who can have the discipline and the passion to take on Collins and I'll work as hard as I can to help.

Chang, Chunhua

ROCKLAND

I am originally from East Asia and have lived in the U.S. for nearly 20 years. In 2019, I was so angry at Susan Collins for voting to confirm Brett Kavanaugh that became a U.S. citizen so I could vote against her. I also wanted the kind of protection being a citizen could provide if I was targeted by President Trump's immigration authorities. Since the beginning of the Trump term, I have suffered a lot of anxiety from seeing what ICE is doing to immigrants like myself across the country. In January, I was afraid to leave the house during the ICE surge. Some of my daughters' friends' parents have been abducted by ICE and their children haven't seen them again. As the chair of the Appropriations Committee, Collins has approved massive funding for this agency that threatens my well-being and people like me. We must stop her. That's why I want to be part of the process to nominate a candidate to defeat her. I am introvert, but I can go out and talk to voters when I am inspired or angry. The last time I canvassed for a candidate was for Democratic gubernatorial candidate Libby Mitchell in 2010 because I couldn't stand Eliot Cutler and knew he was bad news. I am ready to join the fight to take

down Susan Collins.

BIPOC, Immigrant/New Mainer

Clark, Steven

UNION

I want us to nominate and support the strongest candidate possible to defeat Collins in Nov.

Disability

Coe, Laurence Anne

ROCKLAND

We must defeat Susan Collins in November and this year I think we can do it based on the momentum built through Platner's campaign and the Democratic governor's race campaigns. I also believe that to defeat Collins it is critical to ensure a transparent and open process for selecting the replacement nominee. While I am a strong supporter of Troy Jackson to become our candidate, I still believe it is important for the Nominating Convention to facilitate a healthy exchange of information about, and constructive discussion of, all candidates who qualify as nominees. We need to ensure that whomever is nominated at the convention is supported and voted for by the greatest possible number of Democrats and independents in Maine. Let's set a new record for voter turnout! Besides attending the convention and participating in the discussions and voting there, I will support the chosen nominee by promoting their candidacy among my personal contacts, distributing campaign literature and lawn signs, posting on social media, writing letters to the editor, helping to organize house/other small meetings, and canvassing (to extent I am physically able). This is the most important election in Maine and one of the most important in the U.S. this year. Our nominee and campaign will be the continuous target of state and national GOP/MAGA dark money and underhanded media attacks in the face of which we must send Susan Collins into retirement! So let's get going!

Cole, Bruce Forrest

CAMDEN

I have been involved in Democratic politics for decades, serving as Camden town chair in the early 2000s and having written the electronic voting machine bills that Hannah Pingree got passed in the first years of her service in the ME Legislature. I also worked to get Chellie elected to the Maine Senate in '92, and to the District 1 House seat. Over those years, I've engaged vigorously with members of my own Party who cluelessly suggested that voting for Collins was a good idea, sometimes in Party meetings. My motivation for beating Collins has much to do with making sure Democrats do not make this grave mistake again. It also arises from the dire, emergent situation we are facing on all fronts today, caused by the GOP's assault on our democracy which threatens our freedom and our very lives in every way imaginable. Ending Collins' career in the Senate is key to bringing sanity and morality back into our federal government. My intention is to work tirelessly in the

next 4 months to that end, by working with whomever our Party selects in this process to run against her, in whatever capacity I can – whether it be door knocking, phone banking, sign placement, writing ad copy, or speech writing. I have done all those things in the past and am familiar with election support. I will also speak to everyone in my social orbit about not just voting for our Senate candidate, but also engaging themselves in gotv

Colquhoun, Michaela M

CAMDEN

I believe in this country and I believe even more in the people of Maine. We must carry on with the work begun with Graham Platner, and not let go of the sense of purpose and the determination we developed in the last year. The goal of unseating Susan Collins and the need for our elected officials to reflect the will of the people of our state are still as important as they ever were. I've been a volunteer with the Platner campaign going back to the Graham camp last fall, recruiting volunteers, distributing signs, and knocking on doors. I've served as a part of the Graham Camper Leadership team. If selected as a delegate, I would put that same energy into helping to select and support our Democratic candidate for the U.S. Senate.

Conkling, Micah

CAMDEN

I am adamant that Susan Collins be defeated on the November ballot because she has supported the funding of genocide in Gaza; enriched the oligarchy class by supporting the Trump tax bills; contributed to the stealing of funds from safety-net and science-based programs for unjust and inhumane DHS projects; eroded human and reproductive rights by confirming Justice Kavanaugh; and has capitulated legislative power to Trump's executive branch; among other terrors. I believe Troy Jackson has the policy platform and broad support in Maine to beat Collins through his past legislative leadership + current endorsements from numerous unions and pro-working-class groups + former supporters of Graham Platner. Maine has a magnified responsibility in this election cycle, and I will continue to support the Maine Democratic Party but only as long as we put forward candidates focused on human rights and economic justice in Maine, the US, and the world. We can't take the risk of continuing to empower the Senate GOP.

Cook, Paul

ROCKLAND

I fear the curtain is dropping on our democracy. The people have spoken. If Platner can't run we must nominate someone of similar values. I want to fight for what he stood for, not who he turned out to be.

Dacso, Clifford

SOUTH THOMASTON

This election is pivotal not just for Maine, but for the entire Country. Standing by idly and merely observing is no longer an option. The campaign thus far articulated sentinel issues such as housing, health care, tax reform, and questions of war and peace that must be addressed forcefully. Maine is the linchpin for the Country and there is little of more existential import than regaining control of the Senate. As the son of refugees from Central Europe before World War II, I have a visceral response to the predations of ICE and the unspeakable policies of this administration. Once again, Maine is on the forefront and Maine Democrats have the opportunity of righting the ship that is in danger of foundering.

Davis, Nancy D

OWLS HEAD

I have been an active Democrat my entire adult life, and consider myself a Democratic Socialist by promoting values instilled in me by my parents (both teachers). My life's work has been in support of the disenfranchised through Legal Aid, Community Mediation, youth development (including gang intervention) and Restorative Justice. While Graham Platner was not my first choice for a Senate candidate, the platform he represented was exactly right. We need to take back our democracy by getting the corporate money out of politics, and expanding the electorate to include those most in need. I plan to help get our chosen candidate elected by continuing my work on voter registration (including at the schools), engaging in hard conversations with skeptics who have not participated at all in past elections, and supporting "get out the vote" initiatives. We can't afford to lose this one!

DeOrsay, Ellen

ROCKLAND

I want to serve as a delegate to support Dr. Nirav Shah to defeat Susan Collins in the November election. I plan to work with his grassroots campaign succeed in electing a senator who will actually listen to the concerns of the people they represent and take action to address those needs.

DeOrsay, Paul

ROCKLAND

I am running to be a delegate to ensure we nominate a candidate that can actually win the general election in November and defeat Susan Collins once and for all. I am excited for the opportunity to participate in this democratic process and will take my responsibility as a voting delegate seriously. The qualities I look for in our Democratic Senate candidate are intelligence, integrity, collegiality, openness and electability. It is my opinion that Dr. Nirav Shah meets these qualifications better than

the other candidates. I am aghast at the meek acquiescence of the Republican Congress to the outrageous and reprehensible leadership of this administration, and I believe that Dr. Shah can beat Susan Collins and help to bring reason back to the Senate.

Degroff, Deborah

WASHINGTON

Ever since I left NYC ten years ago and moved to Maine I have wanted to see Susan Collins be defeated. She is all about feathering her own nest while the middle class and underprivileged have taken back seats. A new era is on the horizon and I want to be a part of it.

Disability

Emery, Dawn Marie

CAMDEN

I believe in service to our community, state, and country. I am committed to the principles of equality, liberty, and justice, and would proudly serve as a delegate to strengthen the fabric of our unraveling democracy.

Faria, Jacob Raymond

WASHINGTON

It would be an honor to be considered as a delegate to the Nominating Convention on behalf of Knox County. I was born and raised in Waldoboro, went to UMaine in Orono and now live in the Town of Washington. This nomination is critical; I have lived in Maine my entire life, and I believe this is our best opportunity to vote Collins out of office that I can remember. Growing up, I worked alongside dairy farmers, teachers and carpenters, and I saw them struggle with the cost of simply raising a family or maintaining a home. In my current profession, I help Mainers like them navigate the State and Federal agencies and departments meant to serve them. I speak with people almost daily who have been affected by federal cuts and other decisions made in Washington that restrict our access to healthcare, increase everyday costs, continue to damage our environment and erode the rights that we hold as Americans. Maine needs a candidate who advocates for policies that will excite and motivate voters from a broad range of backgrounds, including those who do not always support Democrats. I have worked as a field organizer in this county and beyond on federal and state level campaigns with the kind of candidates who can win over the voters we'll need to flip this Senate seat. Regardless of the nominee, I will do anything I can to see that they win in November. I have experience knocking doors, calling voters, recruiting volunteers

Ferra, Susan

SAINT GEORGE

Quite succinctly, I would like to continue the momentum of the progressive caucus and the energy that was the Platner campaign

Fischer, Amy

CAMDEN

I have been an active Knox County and Maine Democrat since 1992. I was fortunate to be asked to be Chellie Pingree's campaign manager for her 4 State Senate races. I went on to manage or help other candidates: Joan Welsh, Dave Miramant, Susan Dorr, Janet Mills and recently was an active volunteer for Hannah's campaign. I was vice chair of Knox County, chair and vice chair of Camden's Municipal Committee. I am seriously discerning about a candidate's character and ability to campaign and govern. I care deeply about who represents our state. My instincts are reliable. I would be honored to be chosen as a delegate to help make this incredibly crucial choice of the right and appropriate candidate for US Senate.

Flynn, Daniel

ROCKLAND

I served as a delegate to the state convention, and would like to continue that work. As the father of younger kids, I feel more vested in the future of this State and Country than I ever have, and I would like to continue to increase my participation in the party, and in my community. I do organizing work, volunteer for campaigns, and will be running for local office myself. I want to participate to help ensure that the movement of young, working class Democrats that coalesced around the Platner campaign continues, and gets a candidate that they can rally behind. Losing the thousands of newly engaged democrats would be tragic, and we should do everything possible to prevent that from happening.

Forgione jr, Ernest A Jr

WASHINGTON

I want to be part of the process that will nominate a candidate that is not a party elite. Who has a background and understanding that can reach across party lines and gain the swing voter.

Frost, Janet L

ROCKPORT

I am deeply concerned by the climate crisis, weakening environmental protections, and our fractured healthcare system. Furthermore, the rollback of voting rights and the erosion of democratic institutions threaten the core of our democracy. I welcome the opportunity to take meaningful action during these challenging times as a Knox County delegate at the state convention. Although Senator Collins has utilized her seniority to bring resources to Maine, she has not aggressively taken action to support our democratic institutions.

Fuller, Christina

ROCKPORT

I'm Cricket Fuller, born and raised in central Maine, now living with my family in Rockport. I didn't grow up with a silver spoon and believe every Mainer should have the same opportunities I benefited from. With friends and family from all walks of life, I'm deeply in touch with the varied perspectives and struggles of folks across Knox County. I have a professional background in education, community engagement, and public policy. I support, volunteer with, or serve(d) on several boards and committees of nonprofits/causes in our area, and was elected to a second term on the SAD 28 and Five Town Community School boards. I plan to use my personal and professional network, my time, and my resources to defeat Susan Collins in November, which we can only do by championing the values and momentum of the Platner campaign. I'm a former get-out-the-vote volunteer and phone banker for Democrats. And I'm confident in the type of messy, but ultimately democratic, process that will bring us our next Democratic nominee for Senate. I recently participated as a Knox County delegate in the Maine Citizens Assembly on Education Priorities, working with education leaders, state legislators, and Mainers of diverse ages, ethnicities, socioeconomic backgrounds, and political views. I am a listener and a doer, with the right experience and perspective to represent our county—and state—in this important and unprecedented process. Above all, I'm a mom to three young kids who believes in the fight for a better future.

Gabrielsen, Michelle

ROCKPORT

As a lifelong Democrat and public educator raised by a first-generation American, I know the power of speaking up and speaking out to ensure that your voice is heard. As a public educator, I have spent almost four decades supporting and building up communities, and in that time, I have met thousands of individuals, creating a strong network of contacts. It is this experience that makes me the perfect delegate. ? This rare moment is an opportunity for Maine Democrats to demonstrate our grit and determination to win back the Senate! The national coverage of this race to date has given us a platform to show our commitment to change for our state and all its citizens. It is time to continue talking to our registered voters through canvassing, both electronically and in-person, as well as

creating opportunities for our newly nominated Senate candidate to hear citizen needs, share policy intentions, and truly listen for the change we crave. This will require the continuation of personal and public appearances to keep Mainers engaged and willing to vote, as well as larger appearances where policy and experience can be shared. One of these big-scale events may be a debate where communities could sponsor watch parties as our message is spread, and be sure to stay connected to neighbors in the precious days that follow. I hope to see you at Cross Arena and would love to share this experience with my son, who is also applying to be a delegate.

Immigrant/New Mainer

Gabrielsen, Thor

ROCKPORT

I am about to enter a PhD program dealing with discrete mathematics that includes the study of voting systems: how they work, don't work, and can best provide the best outcomes for all. This is especially important given the unique circumstances of the process. Being a delegate as a younger Democrat will allow me to experience an aspect of my study firsthand. Additionally, I have provided service to the Democratic Party in the past by phone banking ever since I was in high school and intend to do so digitally while I work on my graduate program. At college, I was a member of the Colby Democrats for four years, which helped organize several events centered around each of the Senate candidates. These events included orchestrating their appearance on campus for questions from the campus community, along with the standard phone banking activities. I've been a lifelong Democrat, although my life has not yet been that long, having inherited my political convictions from my mother, who has worked as a teacher for thirty-eight years. Additionally, my choice of study in mathematics has influenced my politics towards the logical, and more specifically towards the construction of systems that have a purpose and fulfill it. This has been a trait that has appeared more prevalent in Democrats across the last century.

Disability, Youth

Geiger, Valli Denise

ROCKLAND

I am a sitting representative in the state house and I was also a strong Graham Platner supporter. His economic platform is one I fully support and wish to ensure that there are delegates carrying the voices of the 156,000 Mainers in support of the platform. I am committed to supporting one of the candidates who is in support of strongly progressive values, particularly around economic justice. I believe Shenna Bellows is the candidate that most embodies the fierceness and courage that Platner brought to the campaign without the unfortunate past. She has demonstrated calm leadership in the face of the Trump Administration.

Gill, Paul

SAINT GEORGE

I am a local builder and a small business owner in the town of St. George. I have four daughters, one college graduate, two in college, and one in high school. I see this as an opportunity to help advocate for things that will improve their future. The things that matter the most to me are building a sustainable economy in Maine, women's reproductive rights, universal healthcare, and bolstering our social services to help those who need it the most. I would like to see money taken out of politics, real campaign finance reform, and Citizens United repealed. The agenda of the current administration is an insult to the intelligence of the citizens of this country and only seeks to benefit the most privileged in our society. I will do whatever it takes to campaign for somebody who can help tip the scales in our favor, for the citizens of Maine, including my daughters.

Glaser, Ed

ROCKLAND

I want to serve as a delegate to help choose the candidate that will defeat Senator Collins in November. I've been involved with the Knox Democrats for over 40 years, and I want to continue that commitment. As always, I'll be cooking the lobsters at our semi-annual fund raising lobsterbake, making campaign buttons and volunteering my time as needed. As a candidate for the county commission, I will keep working on democratic ideals and putting them into place on a more local level. I am most interested in a candidate that will fight ICE the Trump Agenda, and restore funding to so many programs that help Americans. We all know that we want to put people first, and we have a chance to move the whole country in that direction.

Gove, Judith

CAMDEN

I am a life long democrat and have been actively involved in supporting local, state and national democratic candidates since I was old enough to vote. I currently serve as chair of programs and events for Knox County Dems and on their executive committee. I attend and help organize our monthly meetings and along with a great team of volunteers we provide forums for the community to meet and hear candidates in person. We also invite speakers and state officials from various local and state organizations to discuss and answer questions on topics of great interest to Knox County Dems and wider community. I actively volunteer on campaigns by door to door canvassing, phone banking and help organize and take shifts during election cycles when our Knox Dems Headquarter is open and provides a place to gather with folks coming in for information, yard signs, volunteering. My other big job with Knox County Dems is organizing the Lobster Bake, which provides us with funds for operating expenses. I'm involved because I believe in the democratic process and for standing up for a diverse, equitable and inclusive society that fights for the civil rights, human rights, environmental rights and well being of all, including our new neighbors who come to the US for a better life. I want to

be a delegate to have a vote in the nomination of our DEM candidate for Senate who will reflect and fight for a progressive platform that supports the working and middle class

Grassi, Anthony P

CAMDEN

My name is Tony Grassi. Sally and I have lived in Camden for 22 years. Our two children and five grandchildren all live here. I currently serve on the Boards of numerous Maine non-profits (The Nature Conservancy in Maine, the Kennebec River Restoration Trust, the Mitchell Center for Sustainability Solutions at UMaine Orono, and Butler Parklands) as well as Chairing the Board of TimberHP in Madison, Maine. I have been a supporter of and volunteer for the Graham Platner Campaign. My top priority is seeing that Susan Collins does not represent Maine and provide the majority Trump needs to have a compliant Senate. I believe in the Platner platform and the importance of maintaining the volunteer enthusiasm that platform has generated in the Democratic Party rank and file. The subjects most important for me are the environment, including climate change; affordable housing; universal healthcare; economic inequality; the preservation of our working forests and working waterfronts, and getting money and the corruption it leads to out of politics. I believe that Shenna Bellows not only supports the Platner agenda but also has the best chance to unseat Collins. She will generate enthusiasm among the party's faithful but also can appeal to the State's large population of un-enrolled voters. I will continue to serve as a volunteer if Shenna receives the nomination.

Grassi, Sally S

CAMDEN

My name is Sally Grassi. My husband and I have lived in Maine for 23 years. Our two children and their spouses and five grandchildren also live and work in Maine. I have been volunteering for and contributing to Graham Platner's campaign for the last six months. I am committed to Susan Collin's defeat. At this moment I support Shenna Bellows. She is aligned with Graham's Common Good policies, she is a good communicator, she has worked hard for Maine in her current role as Secretary of State, and she is capable of inspiring broad support among all of Maine's Democrats, unenrolled voters and some Republicans, to unseat Susan Collins. She has shown her willingness to take on our President where he has overstepped his authority and the law. It is all-important that we gain the support of Graham's followers. I believe, with hard work on Shenna's part (and help from Graham) she will gain their support and maintain the inspiration and enthusiasm that Graham has generated. It is paramount that this process be transparent and inclusive of as many MAINE democrats as possible. I would very much like to be part of that process and will continue to work for and support the chosen Democratic candidate.

Gray, Andrea M

SOUTH THOMASTON

We need a nominee who can carry the progressive agenda forward. It's the only way to beat Susan Collins and the voters could not have been more clear in their desire to have a progressive candidate. Troy is the candidate to meet this moment!

Grinnell, Katherine Anna

WASHINGTON

My name is Katherine Grinnell from the Town of Washington. I would like to be a delegate to the Democratic Convention to nominate a US Senate candidate who can beat Susan Collins in November. When Graham Platner announced his candidacy last August, I was immediately drawn to his platform of affordable housing for Maine residents, universal health care, stronger labor unions, and higher taxes for the extremely wealthy. As the daughter of a career Army officer, I agreed with his support of military personnel while disliking our country's involvement in pointless wars. Although Mr. Platner's personal issues have clearly made him unsuitable for candidacy, his platform still lines up with my political beliefs. He won 72% of the vote in the Democratic Primary and I strongly believe that the new Senate candidate should espouse those same principles. I want to be able to say that I did everything in my power to promote a candidate who can continue the same grassroots, populist platform. This platform, which had such support in June, will get voters to the polls in November and allow Mainers to replace Susan Collins in the US Senate. While I will vote "blue no matter who" in the November general election, I will continue to support candidates for local, state, and federal office who represent progressive policies. I pledge my support in both funding and time. This is the way forward to create a better quality of life for all Maine residents.

Gross, Kathleen

WASHINGTON

I wish to serve as a delegate. I've worked on every GOTV, door-knocked, called, and driven. In my small town, we gather, share views and we volunteer. Dems in Maine are squarely facing this task and deadline. We have compelling reasons to unite. Our focus is and must be on flipping the Senate. The media noise is not reflective of reality—no time for a political autopsy. Not now. We need 601 people who can respect and hold the many views of Mainers. Our neighbors and voters include Independents, Mills supporters, Progressives, and Platner sympathizers who see the recent accusations as politically motivated. We need a candidate nimble enough to gather Mainers into a fold at peace with our process, our direction. Our candidate must then pivot to an incisive, aggressive campaign. The tide is against Trump and his enabler, Susan Collins. Our candidate must be able to communicate the ways Collins has let the people of Maine down—enabled Trump—and saddled us to the most regressive Supreme Court in 100 years. Collins accumulated power with her trade-offs and compromises and then didn't use her power for us. We must be ready with the catalogue, the litany of Collins' bad

choices and duplicity. Mainers want accountability...for all the acts of inhumanity, the acts of greed and stupidity. Right now, we need a candidate ready to seek and serve justice--who understands the full range of Mainers' lived experience. A candidate for a new way forward.

Hengerer, James

ROCKLAND

I believe it is important to defeat Susan Collins and place a competent Democrat candidate in the US Senate. We have been too long in having poor representation in our state.

Hengerer, Judith S

ROCKLAND

Running as a delegate to ensure we have the best candidate for November is an important job.

Hirsch, Christopher

THOMASTON

The importance of this Convention cannot be overstated, with a potential to shift control of Congress. Democrats need to defeat Susan Collins and move forward to counter the current autocratic regime. The convention needs to be open to various viewpoints but in the end come up with a united message that can generate the enthusiasm to the level of a Graham Platner. I believe we have the candidates who are capable of doing that. Sent from my iPad

Hokkanen, Dorothy B

CAMDEN

It has been said many times that "This is the most important election of our lives." This time it is absolutely true! Maine is pivotal in this Senate race. If Maine elects a Republican Senator, the Republicans will undoubtedly control the Senate. In the next two years, Trump may be able to appoint two Supreme Court justices to lifetime terms, and do other terrible things that we can't even imagine yet. Without a Democratic Senate, it will be virtually impossible to stop him! This election is much bigger than Maine and Susan Collins. The Supreme Court is at stake, as well as the world economy, matters of war and peace, the role of our country in the world, welfare of people here and around the world, our tolerance of corruption, and much more. It doesn't matter which candidate I might like best, or even who I think would do the best job. This time it only matters who can win! I haven't decided yet who I think that might be. I look forward to hearing all the candidates at the Convention, and then I will decide!

Hopkins, Betsy

ROCKLAND

I would be honored to serve as a delegate to the Nominating Convention because I believe this election is a defining moment for both Maine and our country. As a lifelong Mainer, born in Millinocket, raised in North Yarmouth, and now proud to call Rockland home, I care deeply about the future of our state and the people who live here. I have spent my career in public service supporting individuals with disabilities and their families to access the services and supports they need to live, work, and thrive in their communities. That experience has reinforced my belief that government can and should be a force for good when it is guided by compassion, integrity, and a commitment to serving others. I want to help nominate a candidate who can unite voters, inspire participation, and defeat Susan Collins in November. I plan to volunteer, engage in thoughtful conversations with voters, and encourage friends, neighbors, and colleagues to become involved. I believe that listening respectfully and finding common ground are essential to building trust and strengthening our democracy. Our party's momentum begins at the grassroots level. By welcoming new voices, supporting local volunteers, and continuing to organize in communities across Maine, not just during election season, we can build a stronger, more inclusive coalition and elect leaders who will protect our democracy and create opportunities for all Mainers.

Hunter, Nicole

ROCKPORT

I am seeking the opportunity to serve as a Democratic Party delegate because I believe our party is at a defining moment. This is a time to rebuild trust, strengthen our grassroots, and offer a clear, inspiring vision that speaks to working families, young people, rural communities, and independents alike. Rather than standing on the sidelines, I want to be part of the solution. Like many Democrats, I supported Graham Planter in the last election. Looking back, I believe we CAN and MUST expect more from the candidates who earn our votes. Democrats deserve nominees who inspire confidence, demonstrate integrity, and are fully prepared to lead. Our votes are valuable, and we have a responsibility to use them wisely. Selecting Maine's next United States senator is an important responsibility that calls for thoughtful judgment and a commitment to the future. As a delegate, I would proudly represent Knox County while recognizing that the choices we make will have an impact beyond Maine's borders. I will listen thoughtfully, engage respectfully, and advocate for leadership that unites our party around shared values and an inspiring vision for the future. I am seeking this role because I believe lasting change comes from people who are willing to step forward and serve. I want to help position Democrats to reclaim the U.S. Senate, regain the House of Representatives, and build the broad coalition needed to win the presidency. I would be honored to represent Maine with integrity, determination, and a commitment to moving our

Jenks, Emily A

THOMASTON

I am interested in being a delegate for Shenna Bellows because I believe she is the best person to beat Susan Collins. I voted for Shenna for governor and I believe that she has a platform closest to Graham Platner's for US Senate, and I have watched how she has fought for the State of Maine as a Maine Senator and as our Secretary of State. She has already proven herself tough enough to stand up to DJT. She knows what is right and she doesn't back down. I am part of several groups that hold democracy circles rallying people around candidates that are progressive, protests against this current regime, and get out the vote groups. I am willing to work for Shenna to get her elected and win in November by doing more of the same and whatever it takes.

Jones, Judith D

HOPE

I support Dr Nirav Shah As a candidate for the Maine US Senator position because I feel he has the background, education, experience, and familiarity with Main that the position requires. He will represent Main well.He knows how to work with people in senior positions as well as the working people in Maine.

Kaplan, Andrew

CAMDEN

I'm Andy Kaplan from Camden. I'm a life-long democrat. For decades I phone-banked, knocked on doors, gave money. Somewhere around when Obama and Geithner decided saving the banks was more important than saving the people, I lost faith that just electing dems was enough. I checked out of politics and focused on my family. The last few years have been a real wake-up call. I remember a t-shirt in '04 that said "Elect Kerry - Go Backwards More Slowly." Seemed funny then, but not so funny anymore. Platner's campaign gave me hope that politics could make a difference, and made me believe again that we could create a better world for our kids. I can't describe how disappointing the last few weeks have been. I guess I don't have to , because most of you feel the same way. I'd be lying if I said any of the candidates now made me feel the same sense of possibility I felt with Graham. But I realize now that things actually can get worse quickly, and doing nothing isn't an option. Of the candidates so far, Troy Jackson is the one who seems most authentically committed to the kind of change that Graham embodied. To me, he's the mostly likely to convince non-voters that it's worthwhile to show up, and that's the only way we can beat Susan Collins. We've already tried "Susan Collins, but a little better on abortion" five times, and it hasn't worked. This time, let's try something different!

Kelly, William C Jr

ROCKPORT

PLEASE VOTE FOR ME, WILLIAM (“BILL”) KELLY. This nominating convention is without precedent in Maine. The decision we make as to which candidate to nominate will have significant consequences not only for the state, but the nation as well. It is important that we select delegates who have demonstrated their ability to understand and represent the views, values, and concerns of local – both Knox County and Maine - and national Democrats. I have done that for the past 8 years by being an active member of KCDC. This includes, but is not limited to, KCDC’s Communications Committee, focused on producing our monthly newsletter, and its representative on the state party’s Rules Committee. My close ties to our community will guide me in helping choose a Senate candidate who can inspire us with their vision and integrity, represent and fight for our Democratic values and priorities, and defeat Susan Collins. I will take this responsibility seriously by learning about the candidates, considering their qualifications and priorities, and supporting the person I believe best represents our values and who can best lead us to victory in November. To achieve that goal, I would do what I’ve done in past campaigns: volunteer at HQ, canvas door-to-door, collaborate in production of press releases, newsletters, voter guides, and other campaign materials, and always spread the message that our candidate is one we will be proud to have represent us in Washington DC.

LGBTQIA+

Kempe, Martha

CAMDEN

We must bring new leadership to the Maine Senate by defeating Susan Collins. Our path forward relies on the bold Democratic platform proposed by Platner. Bringing my deep experience in school leadership and education, I am dedicated to finding a battle-tested candidate. Maine deserves a leader with the grit, integrity, and popular support to turn our platform into reality.

Kiermaier, Annie G

ROCKPORT

It is up to all of us to carry Graham Platner’s inspiration, and policy solutions forward as we nominate our next candidate for Senate. Our country needs to bring an end to corruption, to this autocratic regime and return to democracy, the rule of law and the participation of all citizens to form a “more perfect union.” As a member of the LGBTQ community, I fear for myself and all marginalized people whose very existence is threatened today. I hope the delegates will include representation from all marginalized groups. Now more than ever, our voices need to be included. I will listen to the voices of those who attend the caucus and carry that forward to the convention. I will listen at the convention and vote for the candidate who can best support all of us, We the People, to fight to keep our democracy, and send a Democrat to represent us in the Senate.

LGBTQIA+

Kijewski, Betty

THOMASTON

As a lifelong Democrat, I've seen the political center shift right to the point where the left feels unfamiliar. We have a chance to support a candidate who is both progressive and ethical. Mr. Platner had the right message, though he was the wrong candidate; it was his message that inspired voters. Ignoring that risks our success as Democrats. My years as a professional community organizer have equipped me with skills that I will leverage to defeat Susan Collins.

Killea, Frances

APPLETON

I believe in the power of people to create change and I believe it's possible to elect someone who truly has the best interests of Maine people in mind when taking action in the US senate. I want to be part of the process of bringing real change for the better to Maine and this country.

Klapatch, Mariah L

OWLS HEAD

As a delegate, the perspective I offer Knox County is shaped by being born and raised here as well as spending time away in several other states. I learned what civic participation meant in those states and in 2018 chose to move home, where I believe we have truly begun to actualize the potential of our circumstances. Candidly, I am a Millennial and work for a living and I would like those perspectives represented in this process; I see the people of Maine meeting this moment as best we can and for me that means representing our county in this impactful and historic decision. My parents had careers working for the state and raised me to understand civic engagement as a responsibility. I accompanied my dad when he volunteered at the polls and door knocked for Democratic candidates. As an adult I continue to value engaging my community through conversation and action and am committed to being thoughtful with what I hear and see. Being civically responsible means staying informed on what's going on, educated about why and able to communicate about both. If I don't understand something I slow down and learn. When voting, I don't make decisions about a candidate without clearly understanding their platform. I keep up with news sources across the left spectrum, seek out progressive thinkers, attend municipal government meetings and volunteer. I intend to put these skills and my inherent enthusiasm to use campaigning for whichever candidate we choose.

LGBTQIA+, Underrepresented Religion

Krakowsky, Lorenzo

OWLS HEAD

My name is Lorenzo Krakowsky and I live in Owls Head. I have been a teacher for my entire life, and I have also served as a High School and Elementary School Principal. My work as a teacher and school leader has always focused on helping to give everyone a voice. I believe very strongly in a democratic and participatory process, and I have progressive values. I care deeply about affordability, accessible housing and health care, public education, and the environment. I also believe that we need to reform the way elections are run so that they are transparent and fair, and that we must protect the rights of immigrants. I am also a strong supporter of LGBTQ+ rights. I have recently been part of a strong grassroots movement to elect a progressive candidate to the US Senate, which taught me the value of building community and staying true to what really matters to Maine voters. I think that the best way to defeat Susan Collins is to continue to build on that grassroots momentum by championing the issues that matter the most to us. If I am selected as a delegate, I will carry those values to the convention and beyond. I will continue to be involved in grassroots organizing and will do anything I can to unseat Susan Collins.

Immigrant/New Mainer

Kraus, Arleigh

WARREN

This is a key race for the entire country. We need to obtain the majority in the Senate and put a candidate in place for the senate who will represent the will of the people not the Will of the corporations. Susan Collins has demonstrated over and over again from her Supreme Court nomination endorsements to supporting the war in Iran and policies of the Trump administration from the SAVE act to ICE brutalizing and murdering citizens and non citizens. Incarceration of citizens and non-citizens including children without due process as well as deportation. Susan Collins needs to be defeated and we need to select a candidate as a united Maine Democratic Party that can achieve this. We must start putting people first. We need healthcare. We need childcare. We need to protect LGBT and other's rights. We need affordable housing, and education. We need the CDC to be functional and we need to be back in the world health organization. We need a part of the global climate initiative to combat climate change This is just a small part of why we need to take very seriously the process of nominating a democratic senatorial candidate that will not only represent Maine's values but the values of our constitution and the United States.

BIPOC

LaBonte, Peter

CUSHING

I respectfully submit my candidacy to serve as a delegate to the Nominating Convention, drawing on a record of sustained engagement in Democratic politics at both the national and local levels. My campaign experience has given me practical insight into effective organizing, voter outreach, and message discipline. I have also chaired coalitions composed of representatives from diverse community organizations, developing the judgment and consensus-building skills necessary to navigate a decision of this importance on behalf of Maine Democrats. Should I be selected as a delegate, my central objective will be to help nominate the candidate best positioned to defeat Susan Collins in November. This requires more than assessing credentials on paper. It is essential that our replacement nominee be capable of capturing the same energy and appetite for change that animated so many voters around the candidate we are replacing. I intend to weigh candidates carefully against this standard, ensuring our nominee can inspire, not merely satisfy, the coalition we need to win. Beyond the convention, I am committed to reinforcing our grassroots momentum. Within my own community, I will reach out to all voters, not only Democrats, to convene conversations about the issues that matter most to them and explain how our candidate's platform speaks to those concerns. This kind of direct engagement builds trust, expands our coalition, and ensures our message reaches beyond the base. I would be honored to represent you as a delegate, and I am committed to this effort with the seriousness it deserves.

Langelier, Raymond Lucien

UNION

I know Troy has been a proven leader in the Maine legislature and committed to a progressive agenda for our country.

Lawrence, Russell Jr

SOUTH THOMASTON

I knocked on doors every Saturday for the 2020 Senate election and counted the votes in a local school gym on election night. I did my best to safely and effectively reach out to the voters during the pandemic so their voices and concerns would be heard. I drove all over Midcoast Maine to reach out to small town, suburban, and rural voters to have important conversations about the issues and what state level politics means to them. I wish to serve Knox county as a delegate to select a new Senate candidate for the 2026 midterm election. I wish to serve to select a new candidate who will defeat Susan Collins in November, who will act as a critical vote in close Senate votes, and who will better represent the people and interests of Maine than Susan Collins. I wish to elect a unity candidate in Bangor on the 25th who will have professional experience in government, bold new ideas, and youthful energy. The voters deserve an experienced and competent candidate who will properly

represent them in the halls of power.

Underrepresented Religion, Youth

Lawson, Doreen

ROCKPORT

I would like to serve as a delegate because I believe our country is in peril in the hands of Donald Trump. Defeating Susan Collins is crucial to saving our democracy and combatting corruption. Defeating Susan Collins is also crucial for the people of Maine because we need more affordable healthcare and we need to protect our environment. I am so proud to be a citizen of Maine! In the fall I will speak with neighbors and volunteer to defeat Susan Collins.

Leafsong, Sage

ROCKLAND

I am running to serve as a delegate in the Nominating Convention because this is a critical moment in Maine politics. We need to ensure the process is fair, and that it results in a candidate who truly represents the people of Maine. I hold a degree from the College of the Atlantic and recently returned to Maine after finishing a master's degree at RISD. I was born and raised in rural Maine and know firsthand how politics can be the deciding difference in whether someone can afford a home, to see a doctor, or put food on the table. This insight into how politics can support or knock down vulnerable Mainers deepened during my two years working for the Maine Volunteer Lawyers Project, where I connected low-income, unhoused, and minority Mainers with free legal service. In 2020, as a Field Organizer for the Maine Dems, I spent months having conversations with voters about what they needed--and weren't getting--from their government. As a delegate, I will advocate for the candidate who has a real, clear plan to improve Mainers' lives. A candidate who takes rural and working-class communities seriously, who will support tribal sovereignty, and who has the integrity to build support and beat Susan Collins. I will advocate for a fair and transparent nominating process, and will support the candidate whom Mainers can trust and who can win in November.

Leber, Alexander

ROCKLAND

I would like to serve as a delegate to the Nominating Convention because I want working people to have a stronger voice in Maine politics. Troy Jackson has shown that he understands rural communities, organized labor, and the economic pressures many Mainers face. I want to support a candidate who will fight for affordable housing, stronger worker rights, and ends the abuses and fear caused by ICE. To help defeat Susan Collins in November, I plan to speak directly with voters, and encourage friends, coworkers, and community members to become involved. I work in health care and attend nursing school, so I regularly meet people who are affected by high housing costs, low wages, and political decisions made without enough input from working families. I also want to help

continue building grassroots momentum by reaching people who may feel ignored or disconnected from politics. I plan to have lots of conversations, support local organizers, and show up throughout the campaign. I believe we can win.

Ledoux, Edward

ROCKLAND

I have lived in Maine for six years, and have grown to love this state and the people who call it home. Susan Collins may have been the right senator for us in a different era, but it's beyond time for a change, and I would like to take part in the selection of the Democratic nominee to oppose her. I have volunteered for Democratic campaigns for over a decade, and understand the importance of having a strong candidate with an extensive ground game. Graham Platner's rise showed that people are hungry for change given the actions of the current Republican administration. His replacement must walk a fine line--keep to Platner's message, which resonated so well, while showing that they can defeat a formidable five term incumbent. Additionally, they must show that they have good character, and provide a contrast to Platner in that sense. This fall I plan to knock on doors, donate money, help staff events, and anything else needed to help defeat Susan Collins. I plan on being more active in the Knox county Dems to help organize the grassroots energy that is so evident right now.

Leser, Norbert

VINALHAVEN

I have been a resident of Maine for 30 years and gained US citizenship in 2019, specifically for the purpose of voting. I registered with the Democratic Party since then but have always actively supported the Democrats, specifically since Obama's candidacy. Having grown up in Germany, my experience with the aftermath of fascism has given me the insight and energy to point out and fight the danger of Trump since he first descended on the escalator. Even without voting rights back then, I have supported the grassroots movement here in Maine as well as in NY and NH. We created a "JustTheFacts" group on Vinalhaven immediately after Trumps 2nd election, and I have been an active member ever since. I canvassed for Democrat candidates (including Golden in District2) and volunteered as Poll Observer several times in ME and NH, specifically because of dangerously increasing voter suppression. Because of this intensifying of voter suppression I am very concerned about voter turnout at this upcoming election. For our candidate to defeat Collins I consider it imperative to have someone who can engage all of the potential voters in Maine, rural and coastal, similar to the spirit and charisma that Graham Platner projected. We have to have a candidate who can speak to and truly empathize with us working class people in Maine. While I am a resident on Vinalhaven island, it is possible for me to arrange with friends on the mainland so I can attend the Nomination Convention in person for

Leuthy, Karin Jeanne

CAMDEN

I've worked in service of progressive causes in Maine for the past 10 years. In the aftermath of Trump's first election win, I founded a statewide all-volunteer civic action group (Suit Up Maine) with a mission to build a more informed and engaged electorate. For the past four years, I've been part of the team at Maine Center for Economic Policy, a backbone organization for economic policy research, analysis, and advocacy. In that capacity I am involved in several key progressive coalitions, including Mainers For Tax Fairness, Wabanaki Alliance Coalition, Maine Immigrants Rights Coalition, and Coalition On Racial Equity. I am also an appointed commissioner on Maine's Permanent Commission on the Status of Racial, Indigenous, and Tribal Populations. I've worked directly with Maine lawmakers, advocates, and grassroots organizers to secure key policy wins in the last four years, including the new millionaire tax, paid family and medical leave, minimum wage protection for farm workers, and key worker protections, while also working to mitigate the harm coming from the Trump administration's actions. If selected as your delegate, I'll prioritize listening to what Knox county Democrats and unenrolled voters say they're looking for in a candidate, using that information to guide my vote at the convention, and doing everything I can to keep all Knox county Mainers informed and engaged in this process. Thank you for considering me and for being involved in this important effort!

Levine, Amy

APPLETON

In order to defeat Senator Collins, it is imperative that our new nominee be the one who best represents the will of the voters. Regardless of the issues which led to Graham Platner withdrawing his candidacy, his campaign was extraordinary, creating a grassroots swell of support unprecedented in Maine electoral history. He did this by recognizing our yearning for meaningful change and understanding the anger folks here feel about our needs being ignored, and by channeling that energy. Clearly, this was a galvanizing strategy as 72% of us voted for the changes he ignited, for a future which represents the interests of everyday Mainers, for those values held most dear-universal healthcare, a return to the protection of our precious environment, reproductive freedom, support for public education, social and economic justice, making certain that billionaires, millionaires, and corporations pay their fair share, and ending the rampant corruption of our government. Our candidate must align with these ideals, to respect the will of the 150,000 voters who supported Platner, including the unenrolled who are unable to participate in this Convention. It is critically important that Convention delegates recognize that not everyone votes along party lines. Increasingly, greater numbers of the electorate are values/issues voters. While I believe that Shenna Bellows best exemplifies these values, with Troy Jackson running a close second, as a delegate, I will keep an open mind and vote for the candidate who both shares these ideals and can win in the general election.

Lock, Timothy Antonio

HOPE

At this unique moment in our state's history, Maine Democrat delegates have the opportunity to reflect on the desires of our fellow citizens in the largest turnout of voters ever in a Senate primary. The voice of our state was clear. We want a candidate capable of reflecting Maine working class values; we want a candidate who supports health and wellbeing of our entire population. We want a candidate who wants to protect Maine from outside oligarchical corporate interests who only value what can be extracted from our state at the expensive of our land, resources, and our people. We want a candidate who wishes to treat all people equally, regardless of race, gender identity, or sexual preference. I grew up in Ellsworth, Maine, and returned to Maine with my wife and now 15-year-old teenager in 2012. I have devoted much of my free time to my community in Hope, where I am a three-time elected member of the Hope School Board (chair for seven years). I also work diligently in climate advocacy around the built environment and have advised the Biden Administration's Climate Policy Office on building decarbonization. I want to give back again in a time when we most need consensus and clear collaboration to represent all that makes our state great. To lean on our internal knowledge and select someone for US. Oddly enough, though we didn't want it, we have been given a unique opportunity to do something amazing together. I can't wait to help.

MacDonald-Rodgers, Barbara Jean

ROCKPORT

I grew up in Waterville and have lived in Rockport since 2010. It would be my pleasure to stand up for those who believe in the freedoms of all people. As a lifelong Democrat I will be an objective representative of all Democrats in Knox county. Like many, I trusted Collins long ago but no more. People of all genders, sexual orientation, economic, racial diversity, those on the spectrum of education, mental and physical health deserve fair representation with integrity. We all deserve to live a life of peace without fear. Things must change. Platner's message was a fireball that spread hope that we could bring this change. It was a catalyst. His role complete, it is time to bring forward a candidate to carry this momentum forward. I will represent that message. Thank you for the opportunity to be involved in this important election.

MacNeil-Densmore, Susan

CAMDEN

For decades I, and many others raised in New England, thought Susan Collins was a centrist and ally of the Democratic Party. In the past decade she has shown herself to be an opponent to progressive thinking and the concerns of the people of her state and region. She has manipulated her constituency by voting liberally when her vote would not betray the Republican agenda. She has proven herself to be a loyalist to Trump. Democrats must build on the momentum now gathering to bring back truth, justice, morality, ethics and a government that works for common folk, not for

billionaires and authoritarians. I am active in a grassroots organization that rallies weekly in support of democratic ideals, not a unitary executive or tyranny. I am an activist who opposes the current kakistocracy (leadership by incompetents) and kleptocracy of the Trump administration. I work to bring back an America of fairness, respect, equal rights under the law, due process and civility. A Congressional representative's job is to negotiate, debate and compromise to design best policy for the American people, not for big business or themselves. Wealth should not equal power. We fare better under a collective moral conscience than being directed by greed. I work for democratic ideals.

Underrepresented Religion

Malo, Richard

CAMDEN

As a healthcare worker, it's naturally my belief and duty to advocate for community members. Although deeply personal, true advocacy lies outside of one's own set of preferences and focuses on the desires of who is represented and served. So often, political representatives lose that sight and promote what drives them individually. Vying for this delegate position is less about me but precisely about representing the voices and wishes of Knox county's voters. As strongly as I feel about the recent issues surrounding our prior Senate candidate and the overwhelming importance of removing Susan Collins from office, if nominated, I will seek out the opinions and hopes for this nominee replacement by speaking directly with our registered voters and coalescing the sentiment of Knox county, not simply imparting my own opinions. Not long ago, democratic voters were left out of a pivotal process of choosing their presidential candidate and this unprecedented senate nomination has a high risk of doing the same. I believe, in lieu of a snap primary, the MDP and chosen delegates can provide the most inclusive and open process to Maine's democratic voters. There is no guesswork in what voters want. The primaries made it abundantly clear what type of politics Mainers desire to unify and move forward in November. Unfortunately, the prior nominee was unable to fulfill those duties; now, through candid representation of voters' wishes, Mainers can be provided a Senate nominee that reflects those community needs and carries out the role of Senator dutifully.

Mancuso, Alicia

WARREN

We need to nominate someone who can keep this movement for change going; we need to listen to the people of Maine. I plan on listening to the people I would represent as a delegate. I plan on doing whatever I can to support the nominee, primarily continuing to engage people in conversations about the election on a regular basis. We need to reconnect with everyone.

Marley, Greg A

ROCKLAND

I am assuming that as a county chair I will become a delegate.

Marquez, Annabelle

ROCKPORT

I want to participate in a Democratic process. I have been active in supporting Democratic candidates. I feel that this process needs to be as open and transparent as possible. I am Hispanic and I feel Hispanic representation is imperative. I believe in diversity and in honoring every one's voice.

BIPOC

Martin, Ivy

FRIENDSHIP

Hello. I'm Ivy Martin. I'm a lifelong Democrat who has never missed a vote since I became eligible. I live in Friendship, 4 minutes from where Dale, our general store owner, was hauled out of the store by armed ICE agents and a mile from a lobstering wharf where making a living has more to do with hard work than hardly working. I witness every day the ways in which accessible healthcare, food stability, rational and compassionate immigration enforcement and minimum taxation of billionaires could elevate the lives of my community, Knox County and our country. And, as a lifetime member of the LGBTQ+ community, I know firsthand how respecting others and full inclusion in all aspects of our society can elevate our united nation. I was an active participant in the Platner campaign, was a regular presence at the Rockland standouts, participated in every No Kings event and would only support a candidate who is likely to defeat Susan Collins, stand up to DJT and ascribes to the principles 72% of us voted for in the primary. That is: affordable housing, universal healthcare, economic fairness, ending the slaughter of human beings in our name and using tax dollars, supporting labor rights and human rights and eliminating the massive influence corporations are permitted in our elections, environmental regulations, budgetary decisions and energy policies. I'd be honored to serve as a delegate representing Knox County Democrats.

LGBTQIA+

Martz, Matthew

OWLS HEAD

I am Matt Martz, year-round, full-time Owl's Head resident with my wife and two dogs. I've spent my entire career fighting to get Democrats elected across the country as a national political consultant. I run Street Smart Consulting and know what it takes to win tough races statewide. I worked to elect Gov. John Bel Edwards in Louisiana twice, I'm working for a US Senate race in Florida this cycle, and I

first got involved in Maine politics in 2013 when working for Portland City Councillor Jon Hinck. We are in a fight for our very Democracy and I work to elect candidates who will do what it takes to save our country. Working with labor unions, environmental groups and civil rights organizations, we are registering voters, training candidates and fighting back against Republican attacks on our rights. From working to overturn Republican abortion bans to fighting Trump's attempts to rig the midterms with Gerrymandering, I'm helping push back on Republican extremism across the country. I will use my expertise to help select a candidate who will defeat Susan in November and fight as hard as possible to stop Trump's fascist takeover of our country. We have several great candidates running and I will work tirelessly to help elect whoever we choose for Senate, Hannah Pingree as Governor and Democrats all the way down the ballot.

Mathias, Jeffrey

THOMASTON

As a delegate I would continue to promote the platform & policies of Graham Platner, which won the primary by the largest vote count ever. Having started a democracy/organizing Circle to protect & rebuild our democracy, we are actively organizing people, creating more networked Circles and real People Power in solidarity. Circles can harness power by organizing people in their neighborhoods & precincts. This is how we win.

Matlack, Ann Higgins H

SAINT GEORGE

The results of the Senate primary this June showed Democrats in Maine are fully committed to a progressive platform. As a delegate to the Nominating Convention, I will work tirelessly to ensure we maintain this progressive platform and are represented by a candidate who has a proven record of representing our Democratic positions: ensuring wealthy individuals and corporations pay their fair share of taxes; passing universal health care and protecting women's health care; creating more affordable housing; and reigning in Artificial Intelligence and data centers. I want our party candidate to speak out against ICE and CBP, instead of being merely "concerned". As a State Representative who has served 8 years in the Maine House, I'll promote our candidate by advocating for Democratic issues, doing the type of grassroots canvassing our party has been so successful with, and participating actively in rallies. I will make it clear to voters that Susan Collins stands for everything Maine Democrats oppose: passing tax cuts for the wealthy; confirming incompetent and disingenuous nominees to federal office; offering tepid legislation that does zero to help working class families; and supporting Trump with nearly every vote she casts. We require a strong, capable and confident candidate who will defeat Susan Collins and shatter the moribund Republican majority that's undermining everything our country stands for. I urgently want our candidate to get to Washington, DC and to send Susan Collins home. I hope to do so by becoming a delegate to the Maine Democratic State Convention.

Maus, Pam J

OWLS HEAD

I have long been deeply engaged in Maine politics and take seriously my responsibility as a Democratic voter and citizen. I make a point of getting to know candidates personally whenever possible, attending candidate forums and public events, and carefully studying candidates' positions on the issues facing our state and nation. This involvement has given me a thoughtful understanding of the qualities necessary in a successful nominee: integrity, leadership, the ability to listen to diverse perspectives, and a clear vision for Maine's future. I believe delegates to the nominating caucus have an important responsibility to select a candidate who not only reflects Democratic values but also has the capacity to unite voters and succeed in a statewide election. My longstanding civic engagement, commitment to staying informed, and appreciation for the concerns of Maine's diverse communities enable me to participate in this process in a conscientious and meaningful way. I would consider it an honor to contribute my experience, judgment, and dedication to helping choose a nominee who can effectively represent Maine Democrats and serve the people of our state with distinction.

McCarthy, Heath Wulf

APPLETON

I am proud that MaineDems are founded on integrity by quickly executing a democratic process that is fair and open. We will be SC on our principles and convection that democracy and strong institutions matter. Mainers need a servant leader and that's not SC - she is self-serving

McKechnie, David G

VINALHAVEN

I am a registered voter in the town of Vinalhaven, Maine and a life long Democrat with two elected positions won in the towns of Acton and Shapleigh, Maine. I was a two term member of the Acton School Board and twice elected to the Shapleigh Recreational Committee. I also ran unsuccessfully for the Maine State House in 2000. My resume also includes a 45 year career as a college/university, international school, private school and public school mathematics and science educator. Although my wife and I financially supported various candidates in last month's primary for various candidate positions, as of this writing, I have not decided as to who to support in next weekend's nominating convention. I am eagerly awaiting this week's Thursday evening televised debate. I am looking for a candidate who when nominated and then defeats Susan Collins in November will stand up to Donald Trump and all Republicans who support Mr. Trump, his appointees, nominations, and legislation. If the legislation helps businesses and millionaires (billionaires too of course) before helping Maine and America's citizens the elected Senator should not be supporting said legislation. Their support of climate bills, environmental laws, housing considerations, and judicial appointments need to be forward looking in effect. I thank you for your voting consideration with regard to becoming a delegate from Knox county to the Maine State Democrats nominating convention next weekend.

Meil, Kathleen Elizabeth

CAMDEN

Over the last year, people in Maine have come together in a truly remarkable movement to stand up for each other and unseat Susan Collins. Through countless town halls and community conversations, we've remembered all that unites us and all we can build if we elect a Senator willing to stand up for Maine people and hold billionaires and broken systems to account. Now, with an abbreviated campaign ahead of us, it's essential that we nominate a Senate candidate with the experience, character, grassroots support, and commitment to carrying that momentum through November and beyond. Like so many of us, I'll be knocking on doors, talking to friends and neighbors, and doing all I can to support that candidate. Because I work at the intersection of clean energy policy and politics, I'll also be leveraging my personal, professional, and political experience and relationships to meet this moment.

Meissner, Geoffrey

CUSHING

I'd like to participate in the vote to elect the next Maine democratic nominee for the US Senate. Living in Knox County, in Cushing specifically, I've been active in Democratic politics and have worked to establish a Cushing Democrats group supporting local candidates and advocating for democratic policies. I strongly supported Graham Platner. I'm sorry to see him drop out. In his place I'd like to assure that the next Democratic candidate for US Senate shares the same progressive ideals that Graham did. I'd like to work for that candidate and ensure that the democrats take this seat in the fall election. I think it's important to pick a candidate that we can all get behind, that will energize the electorate, and who can defeat Collins. This is what I intend as a delegate to the Senatorial Election Caucus.

Merrow, Holly A

THOMASTON

Since Graham Platner has had to step down from running against Susan Collins, I have felt a deep loss for the momentum, message, and hope that he created for a better Maine. I would like to become a delegate for Knox County because I want to help choose the next person who can carry on Graham's message, momentum and hope to defeat Susan Collins. If chosen to be a delegate I will volunteer for the nominated candidate, canvassing, and carrying the message that all Mainers deserve a great quality of life with healthcare, good jobs and the ability to buy a home. Please consider me as one of the delegates from Knox County.

Moore, Sandra Estelle

THOMASTON

It is my intent to help Democrats defeat the Republican candidates in November. I have actively taken part in elections for years, canvassing, phone banks, talking to friends. Unlike friends and family that are Republicans I will not and do not spew nasty accusations. We know as Democrats the horrible issues our Country is enduring.

Mrowka, Marcus Peter

CAMDEN

I'm running for delegate because I believe a better future is possible for all, and to secure that better future we need to defeat Susan Collins and elect a Senator who will fight for Maine people. We need a Senator who will fight for bold solutions to make our economy work for working people and take on the billionaires and special interests rigging the rules of our economy and democracy in their favor. I've spent my career fighting for educational and economic opportunity, in the labor movement, as school board leader, and as an activist who has worked on countless political and issue campaigns. I'm a lifelong Democrat and I've already knocked on thousands of doors during the primary season, and plan to continue knocking on doors, making phone calls, and community building to secure victory for our Senate nominee in November. We must be the party and the movement of opportunity over oligarchy, hope over fear, community over chaos, justice over cruelty, and freedom over autocracy. That's what people voted for in the primary, and as a delegate I will ensure that we have a Senate nominee who shares those values and can defeat Susan Collins in November.

LGBTQIA+

Munn, Gregory

UNION

I am undecided yet but have supported Democrats for election since 2000. I plan to listen to all the candidate and choose the person I feel is best qualified and able to defeat Susan Collins in this November's election.

Munn, Noah

ROCKLAND

I'm 26 years old, and I've lived in Maine my entire life. Susan Collins has been a senator longer than I've been alive. As I've gotten older, I've paid more attention to politics, and I've found myself increasingly frustrated by her votes, including her support for continued military aid to Israel and increased funding for ICE, which tragically brought more of its unrestrained violence to our state just yesterday. That's why I want to serve as a delegate. I want to help nominate a candidate who reflects my values, fights

for working people, protects civil rights, and moves our state forward. Between now and November, I plan to volunteer however I can, whether that's canvassing, phone banking, or simply having conversations with people in the community about why this election matters. I believe that change can happen one conversation at a time. I also want to help build on the momentum we're seeing by encouraging more young people to get involved. Too many people my age feel like their voices don't matter, but they do. I want to help build a stronger movement that lasts beyond this election and continues to bring new people into the Democratic Party.

Youth

Murphy, Thomas M

ROCKPORT

I am running to be a delegate because if you are not participating in the process you really don't have much of a say in the outcome. I am a Teamster and a lifelong Democrat and I have voted a straight Democratic ticket since I was able to vote in the 1980s. I have served on Rockport's Select Board, Planning Board, Budget Committee, and Board of Assessment Review. I have been a volunteer for the Knox County Democrats and have done data entry and worked the door at their headquarters before elections. This year I have volunteered for the Graham Platner and Troy Jackson campaigns, and did extensive canvassing for the latter before the primary. The Democrats need to get back to being the party of the New Deal and the Great Society and support their base, which are people who work for a living. I would appreciate your vote and look forward to the Convention in Bangor.

Nash, Mary

FRIENDSHIP

Since moving to Friendship in 2014, I have served as a Democratic town ballot clerk in six elections, even gaveling the polls open on one occasion. The most embarrassing part of ballot-clerking is being thanked for volunteering; I smile and don't tell them that I get paid minimum wage, which I plow back into the town food pantry. More importantly, over all these years and elections, I've watched with dismay our inability to oust Sen. Collins, despite best efforts and good candidates, and I have been astonished to see this year's grass-roots movement stepping up to do exactly that. It has inspired me to be more active in the Knox County Democratic Committee, recently becoming Recording Secretary. It's all about the movement, not merely the standard-bearer. Our opponents see this short-notice nomination process as a big problem for Democrats; I want to be part of the solution, which I see as a renewed opportunity for Democratic victory in fall. National policies must change for the better for Mainers, and it's my fervent hope that as Maine goes, so goes the nation. I'm willing and able to work toward that goal.

Nash, Robert

FRIENDSHIP

I enthusiastically look forward to the opportunity to serve as a delegate to the nominating convention. We must select a candidate for the Senate who represents the values of the Maine Democratic Party and the people of Maine and can serve as effective advocate for Maine. I want to participate in choosing that candidate. After we make our choice, we must unify as a party and present a united front in opposition to Susan Collins. Building on the grassroots movement that has emerged over the past year, we can work together towards victory in November. I want to be part of that movement and will devote my energies to helping our candidate win.

Nilles, Christine

ROCKLAND

My interests are two; participating in the process and sharing my opinions with others to facilitate the unseating of Susan Collins.

O'Brien, Andrew R

ROCKLAND

I would like to be a delegate to the Nominating Convention because I am a lifelong Democrat who believes that defeating Susan Collins is critical to winning back the Senate and stopping President Trump's fascist agenda. Collins played a pivotal role in providing the funding for Trump's secret police. I believe she is partially responsible for the recent killing of cleaner, driver and father Johan Sebastián Durán Guerrero by ICE agents in Biddeford. She advanced the so-called Big Beautiful Bill to slash funding for food assistance and health care for low-income Mainers to give a massive tax cut for the rich. Her actions are destroying our rural health care system. Private equity vultures who have gutted Maine paper mills and destroyed thousands of Maine jobs are backing her candidacy because they know she will always put their interests over working-class people. Collins must be defeated to restore our democracy. I have been deeply involved in Democratic politics for many years. I have served as a state legislator and have volunteered as a canvasser to elect Democratic candidates across the state for a number of election cycles. I will knock on doors for whomever is the Democratic nominee and will do everything I can to send Susan Collins into retirement.

Okma, Cheryl

CAMDEN

I plan to support Nirav Shah as our nominee. I am running to ensure that we defeat Susan Collins. I am excited for the opportunity to participate in this democratic process and will take my responsibility

seriously. As a new member of MPA We need People, Power and Progress. I welcome the opportunity to be part of the democratic process.

Ostergard, James

APPLETON

I just feel strongly that we need to defeat Susan Collins. I supported the ideas of Platner but have always followed Troy as I have worked as a logger for a part of my working life. We need some new energy in the Senate and I say this as an 85 year old life time democrat. I am very discouraged in the current party elites.

Palsgrove, Frederick

ROCKLAND

To help get a person to beat Collins and strengthen the Democrats party in Maine

Parsons, Katharine

ROCKPORT

I believe that being a delegate is the only path forward to represent the people of Maine when they choose a replacement for Democratic candidate Graham Platner. While having another primary would be optimal, there is simply no time. I think the delegates have to be cognizant of the fact that there was a large independent population who voted in the primary for the Democratic candidate and that they are unable to vote to choose his replacement. Delegates ultimately will have to choose a candidate who will be best positioned to defeat Susan Collins.

Paschke, Marie

ROCKLAND

I am a registered Maine Democrat who consistently votes in all local, state, and federal elections. I am interested in assisting the party in choosing who will replace Graham Platner on the November ballot. I did not vote for Platner in the June primary. I want to make sure that the voices of all voters are considered as we choose a new candidate. I want to ensure the voices of his voters and the voices of voters like me are considered in this process. I believe the chosen candidate should carry experience from the political arena, a willingness to listen to the voices of those who feel disenfranchised, a willingness to hear and consider both conservative and liberal points of view while making decisions for the people of Maine. This cannot simply be about defeating Susan Collins. This has to be a person who is willing to continue carrying the ball past the election to serve the best interests of the people of Maine.

Peabody, Alexander Robert King

ROCKLAND

Hello, I'm Alex. Thirty-three years old, born and raised in Rockland. I moved back just over a year ago, and since then I've been active with the Knox Dems. I've been a volunteer for many events, including the first "No Kings" protest and the Governor Candidates forum, and I was a delegate to this year's State Convention. I chose to be active with the Democrats, despite my frustrations with the party and my anarchist leanings, because I believe that electoral politics (especially at the local level) has an important role to play in mitigating the harms caused by late-stage capitalism and rising fascism. I don't know that these are problems that our current system can legislate our way out of, but I would like to vote for a candidate who will do everything in their power to make life easier for people who are struggling. My ideal platform to support would include universal healthcare, strong environmental protections, commitment to labor rights and worker protections, abolishing ICE, ending support for genocide, pushing back against both parties' demonization of trans people, decoupling housing from profit motives, and absolutely gutting military spending to the point that generals have to run around with their arms out making plane noises.

LGBTQIA+, Underrepresented Religion, Youth

Percy, Leila J

WARREN

Dear Knox County Democratic Committee, I am a registered Democrat living in Knox County and would like to be considered as a delegate to the July 25 special nominating convention. I ask for your consideration based on my personal experience in the world of Maine politics: I served as a Maine State Representative from 2002-2010 chairing the Marine Resources Committee & serving on the Agriculture, Conservation & Forestry committee. I have spent a good deal of time since 2011 working on finding candidates to run for the State House not only in Knox County but other counties as well. I am committed to participating in the convention and representing Knox County in a thoughtful and fair manner. Please let me know if there are delegate openings available and what information or steps are needed to complete my application. Thank you for your consideration. Warmly, Leila Jane Percy

Perez, Mirtha

CAMDEN

I am a hispanic woman. It is essential at this time to hear a democratic voice from this community. This is a critical time in our history. Democracy is at stake. My husband Rafael Baeza is the Creative Director at the Farnsworth and lifelong Mainer. We are highly engaged in politics having been there when Graham announced his candidacy and multiple town halls for governor race.

Perkins, Robert C

CAMDEN

To put it simply, Troy Jackson is the real deal. there is no posturing or pretending from troy. Hey months closely represents what 70 percent of democratic voters were voting for in june. When troy speaks about wanting to help ordinary mayners, he is not talking about a class of people.He is talking about people whose names he knows. as such, he may lack the veneer and polish of many current politicians, but he actually knows and feels the problems on a personal level. i met him and spoke to him briefly on the Vinalhaven. Ferry in june, where he was not "working the boat". i just believe in the guy. He is a guy that is experienced in getting things done working in a legislative format. And that is important being a u s senator.

Perry, Benjamin

CAMDEN

As a local minister, board member of OUTMaine, and concerned citizen, I want to ensure we nominate a candidate who can carry forward a strong movement for progressive change. The people of Maine deserve more than Susan Collins, and I would be honored to deliberate with fellow Mainers to nominate a candidate who will deliver the affordable housing, rural healthcare, and fundamental rights we need. As a clergy person, I have lots of experience working within communities to build consensus, and as an activist my work has brought me to our southern border, Minnesota and other places where I have seen the concrete harm that federal policies have enacted. But I'm also someone who loves this state deeply for who we are, and would strive to choose a candidate who embodies those values of fairness, hard work, basic dignity, and love for place and people that make me proud to call Maine home.

Pollack, Andrew J

FRIENDSHIP

If not me, than who? I've been a delegate to the state convention twice, from a former residence in Cumberland county and would faithfully represent Knox County where I have lived the last few years.

Possee, Richard Charles Charles Jr

UNION

I want to make sure that the best candidate wins

Disability

Read, Russell Bartow

APPLETON

The message that Graham Platner had was what I voted for in June and I would like to ensure that that message is not lost or watered down during this process.

Rector, Frederick

CAMDEN

Our country needs help and Maine can lead the way toward a remedy by showing that an entrenched politician and senator can be replaced, beginning to swing the balance of power away from the oligarchs and rampant corruption and back to the people. It's also time for generational change. The job of a Delegate to the special convention is to listen and consider objectively who is the best candidate to beat Susan Collins this fall. Who will tell the story that energizes voters across the political spectrum to bring change to the Senate in November? I believe my experience qualifies me to be a Delegate. My interest in politics predates college, where I majored in government and philosophy. I've worked on political campaigns going back to Eugene McCarthy's in 1968. Since then, I've assisted national, statewide and local candidates for a wide variety of offices. I've held elective office myself as a member of the Camden Selectboard and the Camden Personnel Board. In my business career I hired many people, particularly sales people. And what is campaigning if not selling your ideas to the general population? I believe I can objectively assess and help select the candidate who can win this fall. I'd be honored to be one of the Delegates from Knox County and I hope you'll support me. Rick Rector

Reniche, Kyle

ROCKLAND

After following Maine congressional races for years, I reached the conclusion that the incumbent has a disproportionate advantage. Maine needs a candidate that is not a status quo candidate. As Maine goes, so goes the nation and now is the time for change. As a retired Mainer, I have time to donate to the campaign doing the mundane and necessary tasks such as back office work. I hope this application is received favorably. Sincerely, Kyle A Reniche MSW

Rheault, Christopher Stephen

CAMDEN

I did not support Platner, I am open to all the candidates. I am a lifelong Democrat and former treasurer of the state party.

Richmond, Christopher G

CAMDEN

I believe that the momentum and enthusiasm in Maine's Democratic Party needs to be continued by a candidate who will have the energy and values that Mainers trust to defeat Collins and take back the Senate and our country. We need a candidate who can rally voters from all districts in Maine and gain support from not just the Democratic party but also those on the other side who are disenfranchised with the current administration.

Rockwell, Joan S

CUSHING

I would like to serve as a delegate to the Nominating Convention because I strongly believe in the Democratic Principles, most specifically, citizen participation, accountability, transparency and electoral integrity. I have been a registered Democrat for 61 years, a volunteer for the Maine Democratic Party for four, and an alternate delegate for the 2026 Convention. In addition, I served in the Peace Corps, chaired a local Planning Board, worked on affordable housing and am a member of the of our local food pantry. These valuable experiences have strengthened my commitment to the democratic ideals we are working so hard for and hope to find support in the next elected senate candidate. Defeating Susan Collins will be an uphill battle, but we are ready for this! My plan to defeat Collins includes; 1. Writing letters to major newspapers 2. Discussions with neighbors in person on our candidate's strengths and Collins' weaknesses 3. Hosting candidate's get together for those voters "on the fence" 4. Canvassing 5. Making sure I and others have verified facts about our candidate and Collins 6. Help coordinate and secure signage 7. Volunteer at our county headquarters 8. Donate to the Maine Democratic Party and candidate. Continuing to build on our Party's grassroots momentum will happen through constant effort, support and commitment to this groundswell of needed, desired and effective changes we are experiencing and believe in. We need to form small, diverse, local groups that meet regularly, share a common vision and common goals.

Russo, Carolyn

HOPE

Please consider me as a delegate to represent Knox County Democrats in the upcoming Convention. I am a lifelong Democratic who has been active in the party and in civic engagement in many ways. Actually, my first canvassing job (and not my last) was as a teenager knocking on doors for then Senate candidate Edmund Muskie! Since then, I have never missed a state or federal election. I grew up in Portland, went to college in Farmington, and earned post grad degrees from Orono and Portland. I have lived in Cumberland, Franklin, York, and Hancock Counties, but settled in Knox County 1989 where I pursued my careers in education and law. As a classroom teacher, I taught multiple subjects and grade levels, but always focused on diversity, community, and thought-provoking texts. This included tolerance units, provocative literature, mock elections, and the creation of public service

announcements. My later focus as an attorney included policy and legal analysis for the Maine State Legislature, in both nonpartisan and partisan positions. The crux of my work there was in drafting and promoting legislation. I did this under the direction of Democratic Committee Chairs and as part of the Maine Democratic Senate majority from 2018-2024. Presently, I am retired and am committed to remaining active in local, state, and national politics. The need for action has never been greater. Therefore, I humbly ask for your support and would be honored to represent you as a Knox County Delegate in the Maine Senate Nomination

Russo, Paul

HOPE

am applying to serve as a delegate to the Maine Democratic Senate Nominating Convention because I believe this election represents one of the most important opportunities of our generation to strengthen our democracy. As a retired Maine educator, a Navy veteran, and a lifelong Mainer, I have spent my life serving others and giving back to the community that has given me so much. Retirement has not lessened my commitment to public service. In recent months, I have knocked on doors and collected signatures to support Democratic candidates because I believe that preserving our democracy requires more than concern—it requires action. We must all be willing to do the hard work necessary to build a stronger, more representative government. I believe Senator Susan Collins has failed to provide the leadership this moment demands. Maine has a unique opportunity to help change the balance of power in Washington by electing a senator who will fight for everyday Mainers and for Americans who are struggling to make ends meet and to have their voices heard in our political system. As a convention delegate, I would bring my lifelong commitment to service, my belief in Democratic values, and my desire to help nominate the strongest possible candidate to represent our state. I want my grandchildren to inherit the same freedoms, opportunities, and democratic institutions that shaped my own life growing up in Maine. I would be honored to represent my community and contribute to the effort to build a brighter future for our

Schraml, Kai Allen

UNION

I would like to serve as a delegate because this is an unusually important choice, and I want to help make it carefully, honestly, and with November foremost in mind. Graham Platner's campaign showed that many Maine Democrats are hungry for economic populism, working-class representation, political independence, and a willingness to challenge concentrated wealth and entrenched power. That energy is real, and we should not throw it away. But the circumstances of his withdrawal also make character, judgment, transparency, and thorough vetting essential. I am not interested in choosing the safest-looking candidate on paper. I want the candidate most likely to defeat Susan Collins, and that requires telling ourselves the truth about both strengths and weaknesses. I will look for someone deeply rooted in Maine, credible with rural and working-class voters, able to win support from unenrolled voters, and committed to reproductive freedom, affordable health care and housing, labor and the environment, and democracy. After the convention, I will support the nominee publicly,

volunteer, help organize, talk with voters, and encourage others to stay involved. We will need Platner supporters, longtime Democrats, independents, and people who have felt ignored by politics. I do not think we should confuse caution with electability, or grassroots energy with recklessness. We need a candidate who can combine economic courage with integrity, progressive values with broad appeal, and real change with the steadiness and judgment needed to serve Maine well.

BIPOC, Disability

Semaan, George

WASHINGTON

I am a registered Democrat in Knox county and my wife, Deborah deGroff is an approved delegate. She is disabled and needs assistance which i can provide to her. I also would like to be a delegate to help defeat Susan Collins.

Snyder, Lavana J

CAMDEN

My name is Lavana Snyder. It would be an honor to represent Knox County Democrats at the Convention. I'm running for delegate because I care deeply about getting this right. This fall's Senate race may be the most important Maine has faced in a generation. I believe our nominee should emerge from a process that is fair, thoughtful, and trusted by Democrats and Independents alike — one that puts beating Susan Collins ahead of any single candidate or faction. Knox County politics has been part of my life for thirty years. I've had the privilege of representing our county as a delegate at many state conventions, including last May's primary, and I've served on the Credentials Committee and as Knox County Chair. Closer to home, I've given back to Camden through service on the Planning Board, Budget, Assessment Review, and Personnel Committees. Professionally, I spent twelve years as Project Manager for Maine State Government, working across agencies to help deliver results for Maine people — experience that taught me how to listen, build consensus, and get things done. I come to this role with an open mind and a genuine willingness to listen — to caucus members, fellow delegates, and to the concerns of our neighbors across the district. My only agenda is our shared success in November. While Washington and the national press may be watching how Maine navigates this process, I believe firmly that this choice belongs to Maine voters. I'd be grateful for the chance to help

Souers, David A.

FRIENDSHIP

Wish to be a delegate toward a smooth transition from the Graham Platner campaign to the campaign for our selected candidate. The Platner team is well developed across the state to present a mission popular with Democrats, un enrolled & disaffected Republicans. Platner's established campaign infrastructure includes: fund raising, local organizing & distribution, media, candidate town halls & get

out the vote. This has the potential to get our new candidate with the same mission up & running immediately. I have served in many organizations from volunteer to president. I am the Knox County Democratic Committee Treasurer & Executive Committee member. With KCDC, I have been a DSC representative, volunteer for events & several campaigns. I joined the Maine Gun Safety Coalition as a volunteer & then a board member. I have gone to our State House on many occasions to meet representatives & officials on a variety of issues, giving testimony for and against bills. I know most of the candidates for our Senator selection, and will provide my vote for the candidate presenting the best case to take the movement forward that Graham Platner started. Background: family involved in Friendship, Maine since the 1960s; Friendship Town Democratic Committee president; retired healthcare architect involved with national, state & local healthcare issues; hospital foundation board member; regional planning organization member; founded a regionally successful farmers market as a volunteer, board member & then president when local politics resisted the market; helped community support for the ICE detainee taken from Friendship,

Soutiea, Greg Jacob

SAINT GEORGE

Statman, David

ROCKLAND

I want to continue to do my part to make sure we have the best candidate to beat Susan Collins, who represents the values of the Maine Democratic Party. Someone who is interested in working towards universal health care, finding workable solutions for affordable housing for all, and represents all working people; blue collar, pink collar, white collar, anyone who derives their income from paycheck. I want to continue to be a part of the process in choosing the best person available to represent Maine in the US Senate and working for the Maine Dems to ensure that person wins the election in November. I was a delegate for the first time at this year's Maine Democratic Convention held in Portland and have become more engaged with Knox County Delegates over the past couple of years or so. I helped in the planning of No Kings Rally held last year and have volunteered and continue to volunteer at various Knox Dems events (including the Lobster Bake Fundraiser to be held on August 16). It is my intention to maintain my activity with Maine Dems and Knox Dems through various volunteer activities including knocking on doors, working at tables, campaign events, etc. This activity with the Knox Dems, and ultimately Maine Dems will not end with election day. I expect to continue volunteering afterwards.

Statman, Melissa

ROCKLAND

I want to serve as a delegate because I believe this convention isn't just a formality — it's where grassroots energy from the June 9th primary continues and builds to defeat Susan Collins. As a union member, I've seen firsthand how organized, collective action changes outcomes, and I want to bring that same discipline to defeat Susan Collins. This means doing the unglamorous work: knocking on doors, phone banking, and having one-on-one conversations with neighbors who feel unheard by Washington. I want to bring that ground-level perspective — and my union's organizing experience — into the room where candidates and priorities are chosen. To help defeat Susan Collins, I'm committed to sustained, hands-on organizing rather than relying on national attention alone. That means mobilizing fellow union members and their families, my neighbors, and community members. I will help recruit and train new volunteers, and will host regular canvassing shifts. I'll also help coordinate between labor and local Democratic committees to ensure every town gets consistent voter contact. I respectfully request consideration to serve as a delegate from Knox County

Stinson, Willis III

UNION

I run a small business in Union (The Pour Farm brewery) and am in contact with hundreds of Mainers every week. I believe Susan Collins has betrayed the people of Maine over and over again. It is way past time for a change. I am running to be a delegate to ensure we nominate a candidate who can win the general election in November and defeat Susan Collins once and for all. I plan to support Dr. Nirav Shah as our nominee, and am excited for the opportunity to participate in this democratic process. I will take my responsibility as a voting delegate seriously.

Stoddard, Derek C

SOUTH THOMASTON

Streat, Lorraine

ROCKPORT

As a woman, baby boomer, & citizen of Maine, I believe it is important to be involved in this process. Every demographic should be represented. Every candidate should be reviewed with an open mind but without blinders. This is probably one of the most important elections of my lifetime. I will fulfill my duty to the best of my ability. And I support wholeheartedly the process and respect the final decisions of the delegates.

Strong, Marisa

CAMDEN

It's imperative that we defeat Susan Collins. I am the daughter of a Cuban refugee and I am horrified about ICE's presence and murders in our state. I plan to support Troy Jackson as our nominee and hope those who also support him will select me as a delegate. I want to ensure we nominate a candidate for Senate via a process that is maximally democratic and respects the will of the voters. Given the highly unusual circumstances, Democrats cannot afford a situation that appears compromised by backroom deals or excessive party influence. I appreciate everything that party leadership has done so far to facilitate as smooth and transparent a process as possible.

Taylor, Katherine

NORTH HAVEN

I am a 65-year-old educator teaching Mandarin and Korean in the smallest K-12 school in New England. I regularly observe students trying to absorb the complicated world they are rapidly heading into. Middle and high schoolers acutely feel how much the local and global environments are threatening their futures. Will they be able to afford to stay in Maine? Might they buy a home before age thirty? What about good jobs, severe climate concerns, family, education, geopolitics, and more. The world is behind in most of the 169 targets of the 17 Sustainable Development Goals, impacting the next generation the most. This Senate race is thus particularly critical, and democrats are challenged with an awesome responsibility filled with hope: Pick the best fit Mainer to beat Susan Collins and work with other congressional members to ensure Maine not just survives but truly thrives. I am a mother and step grandmother who fiercely advocates for children in Maine and globally (I worked for the United Nations in food safety and set up partnerships with UN Women and UNICEF to make sure UNOPS projects uses a child lens when assessing China projects). This and more experience abroad and in Maine, combined with being a newly-minted, small island town teacher and a forever Mainer, makes me an excellent delegate candidate. In addition, I am a good listener who contributes to discussions with relevance. I speak kindly. In business, I was known for proposing win-win strategies resulting in success. I care. Pick me please!

Tilton, Scott Cooper

ROCKLAND

I am a long time supporter of Troy Jackson. I admire the strong environmental stances he has taken over the years, as well as his support for Maine's indigenous peoples. I believe Troy will have an excellent chance to defeat Susan Collins. He represents the working class, and his progressive political views are in tune with Maine's current Democratic sensibilities.

Tranfield, Richard Victor

CAMDEN

Fifteen thousand progressive, grass roots volunteers turned out 156,000+ votes for the June 9th primary. That energy supporting the progressive agenda must be mobilized to help defeat Susan Collins in November. A Democratic Senate is critical to Mainers and all Americans to preserve democracy, support the working class, prevent unchecked lawlessness, check the influence of money in politics, and stop the confirmation of dozens more right-wing judges. Given the short timeline to election, I believe the Maine democratic party came up with a good and inclusive procedure. I would like to serve as a delegate in this process to ensure that the chosen candidate incorporates the progressive values that 72% of the democratic primary electorate voted for. To defeat Susan Collins, I will work within the structure of the selected candidate's campaign and across the political spectrum to listen to and engage voters and encourage them to exercise their right to vote. This requires tapping into grassroots enthusiasm and the already-developed volunteer organizing groups. Going forward, I will focus my talents on reaching voters in unlikely spaces, including tabling at existing events, planning and staffing community events, and helping campaign staffers think and execute out of the box! My immediate goal as a delegate is to support the progressive agenda. As such, while nothing is set in stone, I am leaning towards supporting Shenna Bellows as the candidate who best exemplifies the goals of the progressive movement and has the ability to influence her colleagues to support these goals.

Tulis, Jeffrey

WARREN

My name is Jeff Tulis. I live on North Pond in Warren. I am a longtime university professor of political science, recently retired from teaching, though continuing to research and write about problems and pathologies of American politics. I first developed these interests as a college student at Bates decades ago, where I was one of the leaders of Lewiston's large and effective non-violent protest of the Cambodian incursion by the Nixon administration. Since 2016, in addition to my academic work, I have written more than thirty public-facing pieces on the anti-constitutional practices of the Trump administration for The Bulwark; The Atlantic; The Washington Post; Democracy Seminar; The Constitutionalist, and other publications. If elected a Delegate, I hope to use my access to these kinds of venues and to popular political podcasts, to support our nominee and to correct an expected torrent of disinformation regarding the Maine Democratic process. I believe in democratic deliberation and hope to work with fellow Democrats to choose a candidate committed to the values expressed by the Platner campaign who has the experience and skill most likely to defeat Senator Collins.

Velleman, Paul Flor

CAMDEN

I taught critical thinking and statistics to thousands of university students. I apply those critical thinking skills to political speech (unfortunately, often yielding a null result.) My second career as a Maine author has solidified my commitment to the state. My lifelong membership in the ACLU reflects my commitment to the First amendment and individual rights. We must nominate a candidate who will support the progressive values that motivated Mainers to turn out in the primary. I will oppose any candidate who hopes to navigate safely through the current political storms by reefing their sails and moving cautiously. The crimes and corruption of the current administration in D.C. call for a senator who isn't afraid to take strong stands in favor of workers' rights, science, education, healthcare, and affordable housing. Fortunately, several of our potential candidates may meet this standard. I look forward to the discussion and debate. I hope we nominate a candidate I can support with funds and phone-banking.

Ward, Dayle Tognoni

APPLETON

Hi! I'm Dayle Ward. I've lived in Appleton for 23yrs. I've raised my kids and built a business here. It is imperative that the candidate chosen have the same platform as Platner. The momentum behind him was his message; medicare for all, stop funding genocide in Gaza and foreign wars, abolish ICE, end government corruption, get money out of politics, tax the rich, support Labor and press pause on AI. We also have to have someone who will not take any corporate or AIPAC money for their campaign. Anything short of this is ignoring the reasons we find ourselves here in the first place. Trump is not an anomaly, he is a symptom of extreme income inequality and the crushing unaffordability of life here. We have the wealthiest country in the history of the planet and 50% of Americans can not afford to live here. We spend the most money on healthcare and are ranked 35 among 36 of those same countries in health outcomes. While tech billionaires are in the pockets of our government, we have not had a federal privacy law enacted since Reagan signed a law preventing video rental stores from disclosing the movies we rent. The US has no comprehensive national privacy law at a time of unprecedented surveillance. Platner voters were voting for actual change, change we so desperately need, change that shouldn't be too much to ask for and is not radical. Anything short of this, will be handing the seat to Collins.

Wason, Nina

SOUTH THOMASTON

I am applying to be a delegate from Knox County because for the first time in my life I understand the vital importance of the strength of Democratic candidates needed to remove old guard Republicans like Susan Collins from office. I believe it is time for generational change in Congress, time for new voices, new perspectives, new ideas. I say this as a retiree who has seen far too much of what

Senators of my age have done to create the current environmental crisis, a health care system that's the envy of no other country, decimation of a middle class, and a democracy beholden to the ultra wealthy. I support candidates who will work towards fixing these problems.

Weinand, Gerald A

ROCKLAND

The Platform won the nomination. My goal will be to vote for a nominee that will best represent the message and energy that so many supported in the primary.

Wescott McCannell, Kelli Michelle

ROCKLAND

I've worked in social justice nonprofits for over two decades. I have three sons I refuse to surrender to the patriarchy. I also serve as chair of the local school board. I feel called to be a delegate to use my voice to speak for underserved groups who can't be present. I'm prepared to volunteer for the nominee's campaign making phone calls, knocking on doors, whatever needs to get done!

Wexler, Kenneth N

OWLS HEAD

I have been a long time Democrat and supporter Of the Knox County Dems. For 18 years we hosted fund raisers for KCDC and hope to be able to do it again next year. I have served as the OH rep At our caucus and convention in the past If there was ever an all hands on deck moment for the Maine Democrats this is it !! I very much want to be a part of this moment and once and for all be rid of Susan Collins. We have to move beyond her

White, Robert Christopher

WARREN

As a 67 year old, lifelong Democrat, I've witnessed how the national party has for decades only "nibbled around the edges" in making the substantive changes that could truly make a difference for the working class, not willing to offend those in the "middle". Changes such as universal healthcare, getting money out of politics, making the wealthy pay their fair share, childcare, protecting the environment and much, much more. It's obvious that voters nationwide are supporting a progressive agenda and Troy Jackson is the best candidate to deliver that message in Maine. Troy already has support from unions and will appeal to those disenfranchised Trump voters. I believe that Troy also has the grassroots supporters still in place and I'm willing to do whatever I can to help Troy defeat Susan Collins in November.

Winchell, Mary Jo

CAMDEN

I have served on the Executive Board of KCDC as its Corresponding Secretary since 2016, working to ensure a strong progressive voice for Democrats in Knox County. As part of my work, I have lent time and effort to support the campaigns of Democratic candidates in Knox County, as well as those of state and national candidates. I am active in organizing the educational and outreach efforts of our local Democratic committee, such as forums, voter registration, and local caucuses. I am putting myself forward as a delegate to help ensure that the voices of the 78% of Knox County residents who cast ballots in the Democratic primary for U.S. Senate for Graham Platner are represented at the Nominating Convention in choosing an appropriate successor.

York, Penelope

ROCKLAND

I am a current elected official in Knox County serving on Rockland City council and was previously the mayor of Rockland. I have significant interest in the process, affiliated with this caucus and also want to ensure accurate representation of my constituents as they are already coming to me with their feedback, questions and concerns. Because I am already viewed as a leader within this county I think it's a great opportunity for folks to feel directly like they are being supported, and that their voices are being heard.

Ziesing, lucinda

ROCKPORT

I was an early enthusiastic supporter of Graham Platner inviting a diverse community of friends to my house on several occasions to hear him speak. I recognized his ability to galvanize people & reengage them in our democracy with the hope of making their lives and the lives of every Mainer better. In his absence I want to be a delegate to listen to the candidates and choose the strongest candidate to represent the people of Maine and their concerns and defeat Susan Collins in November. They must do this by clarifying how Susan Collins has participated in and with The Trump policies that are so rapidly eroding our democracy and an individual citizens' agency. I want to select the strongest candidate who will continue the movement to build a world without despair and resentment. I will be a fair-minded delegate contributing to an dynamic example of democracy in action at a transparent convention. I will join with other democrats to choose the strongest candidate to flip the Maine senate seat to democratic and ensure that the post- Trump Democratic Party has finally begun in earnest. And we will be able to cheer together, "So goes Maine so goes the nation". Lucinda Ziesing, Knox County.

de la Vega, Cristina

CAMDEN

I'm very interested in being a delegate. I moved to Maine 5 years ago I grew up and lived in Florida. I was a member of the Democratic Party there since I became a citizen at the age of 19. I came from Cuba in 1961 as part of the Peter Pan airlift of children from Cuba. My father had been involved in politics all of his life He was a liberal centrist at odds with both Batista and Castro governments, so like many others we became refugees. My parents joined the Democratic Party in Florida as soon as they could vote. This was very contrary to the majority of Cubans and there were often threatening phone calls to our house. I learned to stand up for your principles and speak up for right and for freedom. The Florida of today is very different than the one I grew up in. Our entire family, three children, four grandchildren my husband and I moved to Maine to be in a democratic state. I am an artist and my husband was a boatbuilder. He is 100% disabled Viet Nam vet. He like many others was sprayed with agent orange during his tours in Viet Nam. A direct link to his cancer and Alzheimer's. I supported Graham Platners campaign because he was a working man ready to stand up for the rights of everyone. I understood he was a flawed candidate but thought his charisma could solidify the common Mainers to come out and

kelly, tina

ROCKLAND

Graham Platner may have been an inappropriate choice based on his undisclosed history of being a douchebag, but his political stance resonated with Maine voters (especially young voters). Troy Jackson's political stance lines up most closely with Platner's, which means he is most likely to be what the voters have already shown that they want. If the DNC runs a middle of the road Democrat they WILL LOSE.

palmiter, seth

ROCKPORT

I am interested to exercise my civic duty to help select an alternate candidate for the US Senate Race. As a registered Maine Democrat, I am committed to a fair, transparent process to select a new candidate to compete against Susan Collins

ward, Thomas

APPLETON

I have only ever voted in elections. I have never been any more involved than that. Since moving here more than twenty years ago I have raised a family and started a business here, which is now successful. But it hasn't been all roses. I have sat on the sidelines and watched the political theater in

my chosen state with growing frustration and apathy but now I feel like it has never been more important to get involved and do what I can to see that Collins is gotten out of office because she doesn't work for us. The republicans aim to strip us of our democracy, and Collins is a willing participant in that effort.